

apps cleverly designed to blend in as normal apps to an unsuspecting user. These apps can harm your well being and online security in innumerable ways. So here are certain necessary precautionary measures you must take

1. Backup

Taking a secure backup is a smart practice because this way, even if your important files and folders are affected by some kind of malicious virus or worm or Trojan, you can always keep your data safe on the cloud. And there are several good services to do this. However don't choose services that ask you to upload all your data without your constant permission or password protection. This way even if your phone were to get infected, you can reset it without the risk of having to lose your data. However, be careful as to what medium you use to take this backup. It should be a trusted source because you can't trust anything and everything on the internet. Some good secure services are Idrive, Sugarsync, Crashplan etc.

2. Security options

Use the security options if the app provides any. Even if someone broke into your phone and now has access to all the applications, you can have security passwords for your applications. Most apps come with an in built provision for this. Even if they don't, there are certain apps like APPLOCK which gives you the provision to secure access to your applications using a security password. It is recommended to have multi security layers so that even if your phone gets lost or broken into, you don't have to worry about anyone accessing your private stuff. Especially with apps with your bank account details such as an e-commerce application.

3. Google Play store

Don't just download from any source. We can't stress enough on this. Most of the online app vendors don't have a thorough safety checks and are loaded with advertisements and misdirection. Don't download applications from unknown sources and don't download applications which don't have a lot of downloads. Even some apps on Google Play store are loaded with unwanted advertisement which might redirect you to unwanted pages or phishing site. Don't give any important information in such applications. They might seem normal and suddenly alert you to an attack on your device. That is your cue. It is always wise to see the number of developers and comments of any app that you want to download. Certain apps you download might